

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Birthright citizenship order paused

NH judge's decision may send issue back to Supreme Court

By Holly Ramer and Mike Catalini
Associated Press

CONCORD, N.H. — A federal judge in New Hampshire issued a ruling Thursday prohibiting Pres-

ident Donald Trump's executive order ending birthright citizenship from taking effect anywhere in the country.

Judge Joseph LaPlante issued a preliminary injunction blocking Trump's order and certified a class action lawsuit including all children who will be affected. The order, which followed an hourlong hearing, included a seven-day stay to allow for appeal.

The Trump administration has fought to end the long-standing law, laid out in the Constitution, that people born in the United States are automatically citizens, regardless of their parents' immigration status.

The judge's decision puts the birthright citizenship issue on a fast track to return to the Supreme Court. The justices could be asked to rule whether the order complies

with their decision last month that limited judges' authority to issue nationwide injunctions.

The class is slightly narrower than that sought by the plaintiffs, who wanted to include parents, but attorneys said that wouldn't make a material difference.

"This is going to protect every single child around the country from this lawless, unconstitutional and cruel executive order,"

said Cody Wofsy, an attorney for the plaintiffs.

The lawsuit was filed on behalf of a pregnant woman, two parents and their infants. It's among numerous cases challenging Trump's January order denying citizenship to those born to parents living in the U.S. illegally or temporarily. The plaintiffs are

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Workers rest behind Goodyear tires at the NASCAR Xfinity Series race in Chicago on Saturday. AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

CRUMB RUBBER

How NASCAR recycles the thousands of tires used over Chicago race weekend

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

During a weekend of hot, high-speed friction against the asphalt of the NASCAR Chicago Street Race course, thousands of tires burn out and wear down. After a few dozen laps, they lose their grip and become obsolete.

But their life cycle doesn't end there. Each NASCAR race weekend, most of the 3,000 tires provided by Goodyear Racing become a fraction of the tens of thousands recycled annually by Liberty Tire Recycling. Before state laws prohibited it, used tires

would be landfilled or stored in stockpiles, said Rick Heinrich, Goodyear's product manager for NASCAR.

"And at a certain point, that's got to be dealt with. We came to the realization that there had to be a new use for these tires, and that's where we're at today," he said. "When they're not usable anymore on the street, they're very suitable when they're turned into a different type of product to make other things, things that are all around us."

In 2024, a total of 215 million tires — including 92,588 from NASCAR — were recycled by

Liberty, a company based in North Carolina that collects and processes racing, as well as auto and truck tires, from all across North America, according to spokesperson John Dowdy.

The ideal would be to reuse a tire for the rest of its life, Dowdy said, which is possible when retailers resell gently used auto or truck tires for less than new ones. But, after being used, racing tires don't usually have any more life left in them, at least in their original form.

At a Liberty facility in Concord, a suburb of Charlotte in North Carolina, NASCAR racing tires are

shredded into quarter-sized chips that can be used as aggregate in roadbeds, landfill liners and landscaping products.

"It's a perfect example of sustainability," Heinrich said. "You're taking stuff that's worn out, you can't use it again for what it was originally built for, but it goes into something else. Nothing is wasted."

The shredded tires can also be used as a more efficient fuel to power kilns and boilers in concrete factories, electric plants and pulp and paper mills.

Turn to Tires, Page 2

Scrutiny of DuPage clerk vexes Democrats

AG probe of official's practices a concern for party's continued success in county

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

When activist Jean Kaczmarek was elected DuPage County clerk seven years ago, she became the first Democrat elected to countywide office in 84 years and her subsequent work as clerk to make voting easier and more available was lauded by the party faithful.

But the appointment of Illinois Attorney General Kwame Raoul's office as special prosecutor to investigate Kaczmarek's office over allegations of official misconduct has prompted concern among Democrats that the gains they have made in wresting significant control of the once strongly Republican suburban county could be at risk.

Kaczmarek, hailed in 2022 by the Democratic Women of DuPage County with its leadership award, is already facing a primary challenge as she seeks a third term next year. And her previous budgetary actions helped lead to a change in state purchasing law for most Illinois counties — a law that is now at the center of the Raoul investigation.

DuPage County Circuit Judge Bonnie Wheaton's order on Monday appointing Raoul's office as special prosecutor is rooted in more than two years of internecine battles between the Democratic clerk and the Democratic-led DuPage County Board involving the often labyrinthine world of budgetary control and power in county governance.

Even before the special prosecutor appointment, each side had filed civil suits against the other over such issues as Kaczmarek's ability to make

Turn to Clerk, Page 2

Several top CPS staffers follow CEO out

Five officials, some with long histories at the district, exit after departure of schools chief Martinez

By Kate Armanini and Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

Several top Chicago Public Schools staff members have left the district following the departure of former schools chief Pedro Martinez.

The five exiting officials include the district's chiefs of information technology, nutrition and multi-lingual education. The district's general counsel also left, as did the former CEO's chief of staff. Martinez's last day as district CEO was June 18. Most left voluntarily, sources familiar with the departures told the Tribune. They declined to give their names because they were not authorized to speak on the record about district personnel matters.

The exiting officials all departed following Martinez's last day on June 18, when interim schools chief Macqueline King took office. King formerly served



People walk past Chicago Public Schools headquarters on West Madison Street on Thursday. CEO Pedro Martinez departed June 18, and several top officials followed. TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

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INSIDE

Police misconduct costs keep soaring

Chicago's spending on police misconduct settlements is likely to climb higher with another \$35.2 million in proposed deals. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

State Farm sharply raises Illinois rates

The insurer is raising homeowners rates in Illinois by 27.2% beginning Aug. 15, according to a filing with the state last month. **Business**

Alerts spotty as Texas floods raged

In the first three hours after the National Weather Service sent out an alert July 4, local leaders would remain largely unheard from. **Nation & World**

